Sergei Bakaleinik

Tech Lead / Senior Backend Engineer

Target roles: Principal Engineer · AI Software Engineer

Moscow, Russia · Remote
s.jr.bakaleynik@gmail.com · LinkedIn · GitHub · Telegram · Portfolio

PROFILE

Backend engineer with 5+ years of experience designing and improving high-load services and API Gateway in cloud environments. Tech Lead at Cloud.ru since August 2026, combining hands-on Python engineering, system design and cross-team coordination. Over a year of LLM-assisted software development, adapting tools and workflows to personal engineering needs. Seeking to apply this foundation in a Principal Engineer or AI Software Engineer role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Python, FastAPI, Django, asyncio, REST API, gRPC, testing, Git
Data & infrastructure: PostgreSQL, SQLAlchemy, Docker, Kubernetes, Temporal
Architecture: System design, solution architecture, microservices, API Gateway
AI-assisted development: Codex, Cursor, GitHub Spec Kit; experience applying model routing (GOAT playbook) to select models and reasoning effort for tasks

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

Technical leadership · Task decomposition · Cross-team communication · Business and technical requirements · Technical interviewing · Knowledge sharing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud.ru | Remote

Tech Lead: August 2026 - Present
Senior Backend Engineer: April 2023 - August 2026

Design and support API Gateway microservices; improve shared Python libraries and engineering practices. Periodically took on management responsibilities for almost two years before the formal Tech Lead appointment.

• Reduced APISIX CPU usage 10× and memory consumption by 30% by redesigning radix tree construction, decoupling gateway and admin layers, and reducing worker overhead.

• Improved client product loading through OpenSSL-based validation and redesigned logic using established cryptographic components.

• Resolved leaks and timeouts in high-load services through SQLAlchemy greenlet fixes and the saga pattern with Temporal.

EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

Cloud.ru

• Established end-to-end audit and user activity logging through cross-team collaboration, architectural design, and clear business and technical requirements.

• Conducted around 50 technical interviews and 5 live-coding sessions in one year; about 10 candidates reached the final stage.

• Contributed documentation and functionality to shared Python libraries, improving developer experience and code reuse.

S7 TechLab | Remote

Middle Backend Engineer · February 2022 - April 2023

Developed and deployed Python and Django REST APIs for an internal ERP system, focusing on reliability and maintainability.

• Automated aircraft maintenance documentation through an open-source HTML-to-PDF integration, replacing manual paperwork and reducing data processing time by 25%. Used hundreds of times daily.

FriFlex | Remote

Middle Backend Engineer · May 2021 - February 2022

Designed backend services for an employee management system covering reference letters, payslips and personnel documentation.

• Built integrations with authentication, payroll/HR, support and an internal news portal, unifying employee information access and helping grow MAU from 1k to 50k.

AI DEVELOPMENT PRACTICE

Over a year of using LLMs to write code, starting with Cursor and now working with Codex. Customize the tooling and development workflow to suit engineering tasks. Have also used GitHub Spec Kit and the Model Routing Playbook (GOAT) approach. Interested in building on this practice in an AI Software Engineer role.

EDUCATION

Innopolis University · Master’s Degree in Data Science · August 2021
Voronezh State University of Engineering Technologies
Bachelor’s Degree in Computer Science · July 2019
Additional education: System design, 28 hours

LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

Russian: Native · **English:** Upper-Intermediate
System design, software architecture, practical LLM applications, cooperative gaming and strategy board games.